

Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

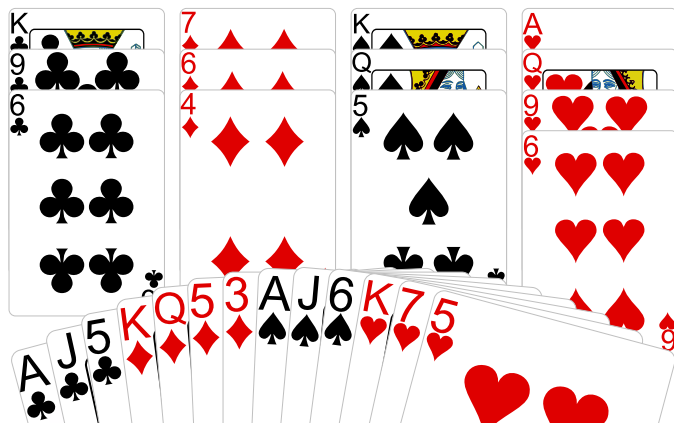
RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.

If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.

If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.

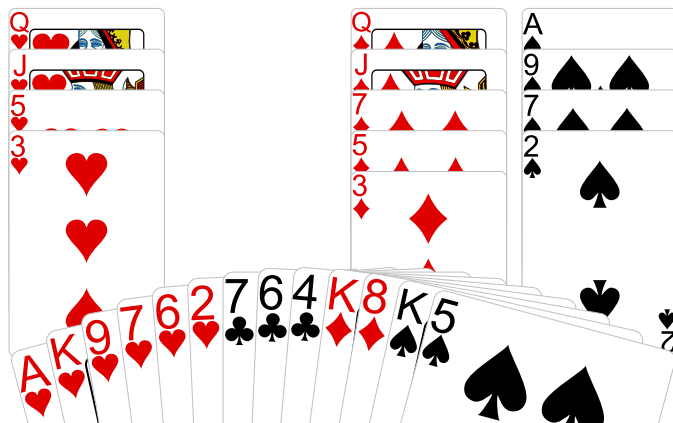
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Deal 1 Ctr: 4NT Goal: at least ____ winners



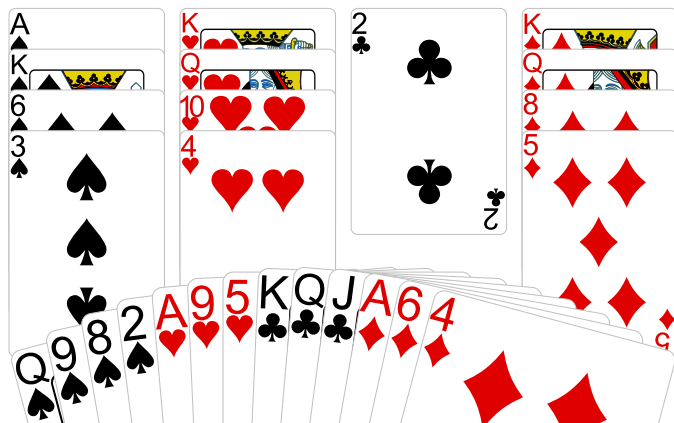
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



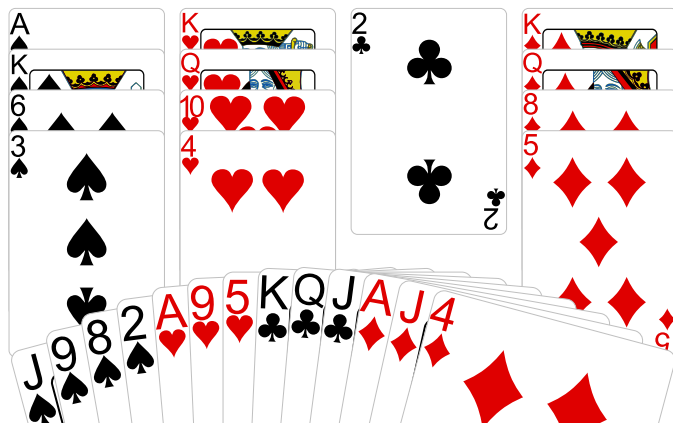
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 5♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 5♠
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 3 2

♥ T 8 2

♦ A J 9

♣ T 8 2

♠ A J 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K Q 5 3

♣ A J 5



♠ T 7 4

♥ J 4 3

♦ T 8 2

♣ Q 7 4 3

♠ K Q 5

♥ A Q 9 6

♦ 7 6 4

♣ K 9 6

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

4NT

All Pass

4NT by North

What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, NORTH showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and SOUTH invited him to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 7 2
♥ Q J 5 3
♦ Q J 7 5 3
♣ -

♠ T 8 6

♥ 8 4

♦ A 4 2

♣ Q T 9 5 3



♠ K 5

♥ A K 9 7 6 2

♦ K 8

♣ 7 6 4

♠ Q J 4 3

♥ T

♦ T 9 6

♣ A K J 8 2

When WEST makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, EAST naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and WEST, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what EAST needed for the 6♥ bid.

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
4♣	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

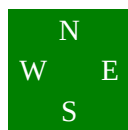
Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 4
♥ J 8 3
♦ T 7 2
♣ A 8 7 6 3

♠ A K 6 3
♥ K Q T 4
♦ K Q 8 5
♣ 2



♠ J 7 5
♥ 7 6 2
♦ J 9 3
♣ T 9 5 4

♠ Q 9 8 2
♥ A 9 5
♦ A 6 4
♣ K Q J

NORTH thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When SOUTH announces four ♠s NORTH uses RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in NORTH's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 8 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ A J 4

♣ K Q J

♠ T 4

♥ J 6 2

♦ 9 7 3

♣ A T 9 8 5



♠ A K 6 3

♥ K Q T 4

♦ K Q 8 5

♣ 2

♠ Q 7 5

♥ 8 7 3

♦ T 6 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

West

1NT

2♠

5♥

All Pass

5♠ by West

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

2♣

4NT

5♠

South

Pass

Pass

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, EAST uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time WEST shows two Key Cards without the ♠ Q.

Now EAST realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 6
♥ 3 2
♦ Q J 8 4
♣ J T 6 3

♠ A K 4

♥ J 9 5

♦ A K 7 6

♣ A 5 4



♠ J T 8 5

♥ T 7

♦ T 9 2

♣ K Q 9 2

♠ 7 3 2

♥ A K Q 8 6 4

♦ 5 3

♣ 8 7

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if NORTH decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when SOUTH shows two Key Cards.

NORTH has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking SOUTH to further describe his hand. SOUTH should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

SOUTH cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so NORTH just passes 3NT.

West	North	East	South
			2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			